Vera handoff design

Oct 19, 2026

The problem

When Vera hands a member to a collections officer, the member should not have to repeat their story, and the officer should not act on numbers the AI typed.

Most handoffs fail on one of those two points. Either the officer starts from zero and re-asks everything, or they get an AI summary with amounts that may be wrong. This design gives the officer a case that is ready to work, with the facts pulled from the collections system at the moment of handoff.

When Vera hands off

Vera hands off for seven reasons. Situations that need care (hardship, bankruptcy, a lawyer, a dispute) are High priority, and Vera pauses payment requests before she asks to connect the member.

What the member says or needs	Reason on the case	Priority	What Vera does first
Asks for a person	MEMBER_REQUEST	Medium	Creates the case (live transfer in production)
Wants something the policy does not allow (fee waiver, a later date, a smaller amount)	POLICY_EXCEPTION	Medium	Explains it is not available here, offers a person
Cannot be verified	VERIFICATION_FAILED	Medium	Shares nothing about the account
Hardship: job loss, illness, a death	HARDSHIP_REVIEW	High	Sets the flag, pauses payment requests, asks before connecting
Filing for bankruptcy	BANKRUPTCY	High	Same as hardship

What the member says or needs	Reason on the case	Priority	What Vera does first
Has a lawyer	ATTORNEY	High	Same as hardship, asks for nothing further about the debt
Says they do not owe it or already paid	DISPUTE	High	Same as hardship, does not argue

A request to stop messages is different: Vera sets the stop flag at once, even before verification, and does not hand off.

What the officer receives

The officer gets one case in the Collections Officers queue. Every number on it comes from the collections system, not from Vera; Vera adds only the reason, a summary and the member's own words.

On the case	Comes from	Why it matters
Reason and priority	Vera picks the reason; the Apex action sets priority from it	Hardship cases are seen first
Account number	The conversation	No searching for the member
Identity verified: yes or no	The Apex action, from Vera's verification	If no, the officer verifies before discussing the account
Days past due, amount past due, late fee, total to bring current, next due date	The collections API, called at handoff time	The officer quotes the same numbers the system holds
Options the policy allows today	The collections API	The officer knows what is already on the table
Member's own words	Quoted exactly by Vera	Tone and intent survive the handoff

On the case	Comes from	Why it matters
Vera's summary	Vera, three to five sentences, no card or bank numbers	A 10-second read instead of a transcript
Transcript	The messaging session, linked to the case	Production only; see below

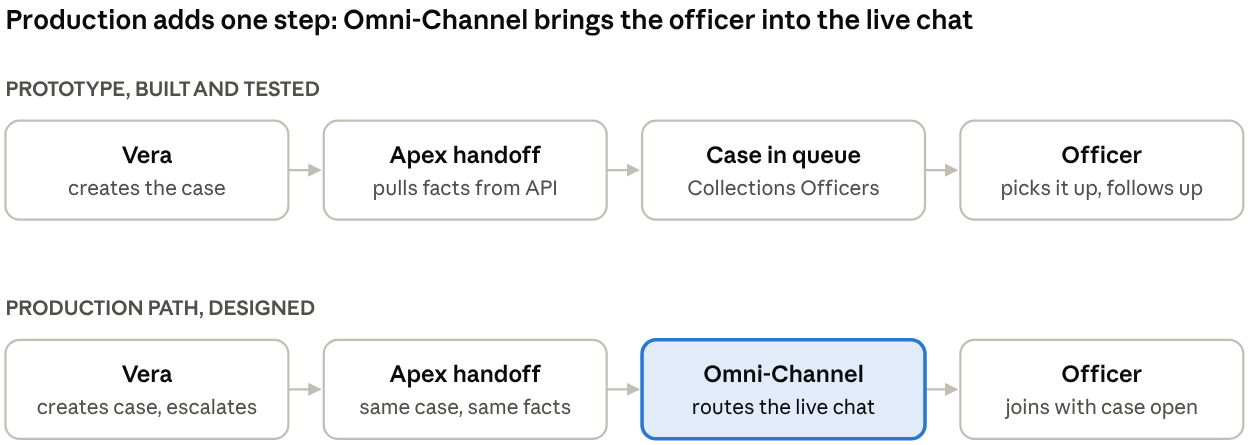
Guardrails and failure handling

A handoff is never lost, and it never carries the wrong member's facts.

- **Collections API down:** the case is still created and says the facts are unavailable, so the officer checks the core system.
- **Member not verified:** no call to the API is made, and the case says "verify before discussing the account".
- **Wrong account given:** the verification is tied to one account, so the API refuses the facts for any other account instead of returning them.
- **Hardship before handoff:** the flag is set before the transfer, so outreach stops even if the member leaves before an officer joins.
- **Privacy:** Vera never asks for or writes card or bank numbers, and never reads the case number or summary back to the member.

Prototype today, production path

The prototype creates the case and stops there; production adds a live transfer so the officer joins the same conversation.



handoff · prototype vs production

In production, Embedded Messaging carries the chat and Omni-Channel routes it to an available officer with the case attached. The Apex action already links the messaging session to the case, but that link is untested because the prototype has no live channel. I chose not to build the live transfer: it is standard Service Cloud setup and adds risk to a live demo.

Evidence and how to measure it

The case handoff runs end to end in the prototype; the live transfer does not yet.

- **Dana (verified, asks for a person):** case 00001026, Medium, showing $572.16 + $25.00 late fee = $597.16 from the API, her words quoted.
- **Ken (job loss, not verified):** case 00001028, HARDSHIP_REVIEW, High, account L-50008, his words about losing his job.
- **Apex tests:** 3 of 3 pass, including the API being down.
- **First test run caught a defect:** Ken's "yes" was routed as a plain request, so the case said Medium with no account. Fixed so Vera reads the whole conversation; re-tested.

In production, measure (targets from today's contact-center numbers):

- How often an officer has to re-ask the member for something already on the case (the core promise)
- Time from handoff to an officer's first reply, by priority
- Share of conversations that end in a handoff, by reason
- Accounts brought current within 30 days after a handoff